Digital Asset Investing

Fourth Turning & the Exponential Age

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NASA → Goldman Sachs → Netscape → Abra

"From Wind-tunnels to Wall Street to the first web browser to the future of money & finance."

Employee ~#50 at Netscape. Watched the Internet go from "this will never work" to "this changes everything" in 4 years. 12 years building in crypto.

What we’ll cover in 80 minutes…

- Bitcoin vs Gold
- Smart Contracts & Killers Apps
- Quantum Computing: Risks vs FUD
- Holding & Managing Crypto
- Algorand - Agentic Commerce
- Openclaw, Crypto & AI Convergence
- Corporate Treasury
- Personal Wealth & The SMA Model

Quick show of hands...

- Who owns any crypto today?
- Who has more than 10% of their net worth in digital assets?
- Who has never bought any?

SECTION 1: THE FOURTH TURNING — BITCOIN VS GOLD

We Are Here

The Strauss-Howe Generational Cycle

1st Turning
HIGH

2nd Turning
AWAKENING

3rd Turning
UNRAVELING

4th Turning
CRISIS ← WE ARE HERE

The last crisis gave us WWII, Bretton Woods, and a complete restructuring of global finance.
This one will too — except the new infrastructure won't be built by governments.

Trust Is Breaking

8%

Trust in Congress

27%

Trust in Banks

16%

Trust in Media

Source: Gallup / Edelman Trust Barometer

Gold: The Crisis Asset for 5,000 Years

+69%	+1,300%	+166%
Great Depression	1970s Stagflation	2008 GFC

Every Fourth Turning, hard assets outperform. But gold has a problem...

Gold in 2026

- Can't program it
- Can't easily divide it below ~$100
- Can't send it in seconds
- Can't verify supply without trusted auditors
- Can't easily earn yield on it
- ~$15T market cap sitting inert

"Gold is an analog store of value in a digital world."

Bitcoin: Digital Gold, But Better

Property	Gold	Bitcoin
Scarce	✅ ~1.5% annual inflation	✅ Hard cap 21M
Portable	❌ Heavy, expensive to move	✅ Send anywhere in minutes
Divisible	❌ ~$100 minimum	✅ 1 sat = $0.001
Verifiable	❌ Assay required	✅ Anyone can verify
Programmable	❌ No	✅ Smart contracts, DeFi
Yield	❌ Storage costs money	✅ 2-5% APY available
Seizure-resistant	🟡 Executive Order 6102	✅ Self-custody possible

The Performance Gap

10-Year Return	BTC ~10,000% vs Gold ~80%
Rolling 4-Year	BTC has never been negative
Market Cap Gap	$1.5T BTC vs $15T Gold — 10× asymmetry

If Bitcoin is the new gold...

What's the new Wall Street?

SECTION 2: SMART CONTRACTS & KILLER APPS

A Vending Machine for Financial Services

Code on a blockchain that executes automatically when conditions are met.

No banker. No broker. No lawyer. No 3-day settlement.

You put money in → the code executes → you get your result.
No intermediary can block it, delay it, or take a cut they didn't earn.

Leaders: Ethereum, BNB, Solana, Cardano, Sui, Aptos, Algorand

The Killer Apps — Today

💵 Stablecoins
$150B+ market. Programmable dollars. AI Agents will use crypto, not banks.

🏦 DeFi Lending
$50B+ TVL. Borrow/lend without a bank.

🏢 Tokenization
BlackRock, Hamilton Lane, real estate. Every asset becomes a token.

🎯 Prediction Markets
Polymarket: $1B+ election volume. Collective intelligence.

💸 AI & Payments
Seconds vs 3-5 day ACH. Cross-border for pennies.

Stablecoins: The Trojan Horse

$150B+ and Growing

The Most Used Crypto Product

- More stablecoin transaction volume than Visa in 2025
- Dollar-denominated, instant settlement, global reach
- "Your grandma won't know she's using crypto — she'll just know the payment was instant and free."

Tokenization: Wall Street Is Coming

- "Every Asset Becomes a Token"
- BlackRock BUIDL fund ($500M+)
- Hamilton Lane, Franklin Templeton on-chain
- Real estate fractions, private equity access, 24/7 trading
- When Larry Fink says tokenization is the next generation for markets — pay attention.

What's Next

- AI agents executing financial transactions autonomously
- Payroll in stablecoins (no more 2-week pay cycles)
- Insurance without insurance companies
- Global equities trading 24/7 (buy SpaceX like you buy SOL)

The infrastructure for all of this is being built right now.

The Netscape Parallel

Netscape Navigator
1995

The browser was the interface
to the Internet

→

Phantom Wallet
2025

The wallet is the interface
to the new financial system

SSL fixed security. Smart contracts fix trust. Same movie, same ending.

SECTION 3: QUANTUM COMPUTING — NARRATIVE FUD

The FUD

"Quantum Computers Will Break Bitcoin" — NYT

"Crypto's Quantum Threat Is Real" — Bloomberg

"The End of Encryption" — Wired

Every cycle has its FUD. Let's look at the math.

What Quantum Would Need to Break Bitcoin

Current state:	**~1,000 noisy qubits (Google Willow)**
Required:	**Millions of stable, error-corrected qubits**
Timeline:	**Most cryptographers say 2040s at earliest**

"Like comparing a paper airplane to a 747. Same concept, completely different engineering."

If Quantum Breaks Bitcoin, It Breaks Everything

- Same cryptography protects: banking (TLS), military comms, nuclear codes
- Your iCloud password, every HTTPS website
- Bitcoin will upgrade FASTER than banks
- BIP process vs Basel III timescale
- If it threatens crypto, it threatens all of finance — and crypto fixes it first.

🧭 The FUD Filter

1. **Does this threat also apply to traditional systems?**

   → Not a crypto problem.

2. **Is the timeline credible?**

   → Check the science, not the headline.

3. **Who benefits from this narrative?**

   → Follow the incentive.

Apply this filter to every scary crypto headline. 90% fail at step one.

SECTION 4: MANAGING YOUR CRYPTO

SMA vs ETF vs EXCHANGE vs WALLET

The Four Ways to Hold Crypto

🏪 **Exchange**

Coinbase, Kraken

🔑 **Self-Custody Wallet**

Ledger, Phantom

📈 **ETF**

BlackRock, Fidelity

🏦 **SMA**

Abra, Bitwise

The right question isn't "what should I buy?" — it's "how should I own it?"

🏪 Exchange — The On-Ramp

- Easy, liquid, broad selection
- NOT your keys → NOT your coins
- FTX lost $8B of customer funds
- Best for: Trading, initial purchases, small amounts
- Exchanges are fine for buying. Terrible for storing.

🔑 Self-Custody — Your Keys, Your Coins

- Maximum sovereignty. No counterparty risk. Censorship-resistant.
- Lose the seed phrase = lose everything
- No fiduciary. No support line. You ARE your own bank.
- Best for: Technically sophisticated, true believers
- If you're managing $10M+ and you're not a cryptographer, self-custody is a risk in itself.

📈 ETF — The Easy Button

- IRA/401k compatible. Familiar brokerage wrapper.
- You don't own Bitcoin — you own shares of a trust
- No yield. No DeFi. No self-custody option. Management fees.
- Best for: Retirement accounts, simplicity, first allocation
- $50B+ in year one. But for this room, an ETF is training wheels.

🏦 SMA — The Answer for This Room

You own the actual assets. Segregated account in your name.

✅ Fiduciary relationship — SEC-registered RIA

✅ Custom strategies & tax-loss harvesting

✅ Direct DeFi yield access

✅ Institutional custody (BitGo, Anchorage)

ETF = buying a gold certificate

SMA = your gold in your own vault with your name on it

Best for: $250K+ allocation, serious investors who want yield + control + a fiduciary

How Should You Hold Crypto?

	Exchange	Wallet	ETF	SMA
You own the asset	❌	✅	❌	✅
Counterparty risk	High	None	Medium	Low
DeFi yield access	Manual	✅	❌	✅
Tax optimization	❌	❌	Limited	✅
Fiduciary	❌	❌	❌	✅
IRA compatible	❌	❌	✅	✅
Minimum	$0	$0	$0	~$250K

SECTION 5: ALGORAND — AGENTIC COMMERCE

Agentic Commerce:
When AI Agents Use Crypto

Marc Vanlerberghe | Algorand Foundation

Agentic Commerce

AP2, x402, and Autonomous Transactions

Marc Vanlerberghe, CSMO
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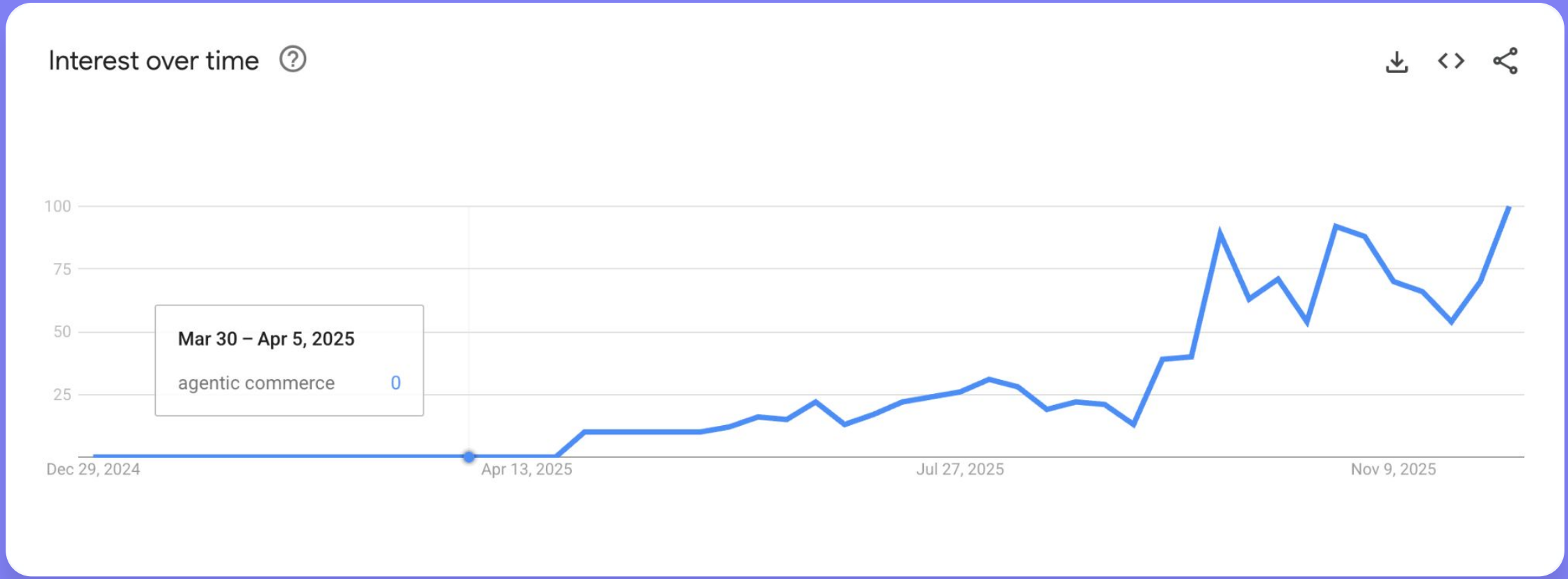
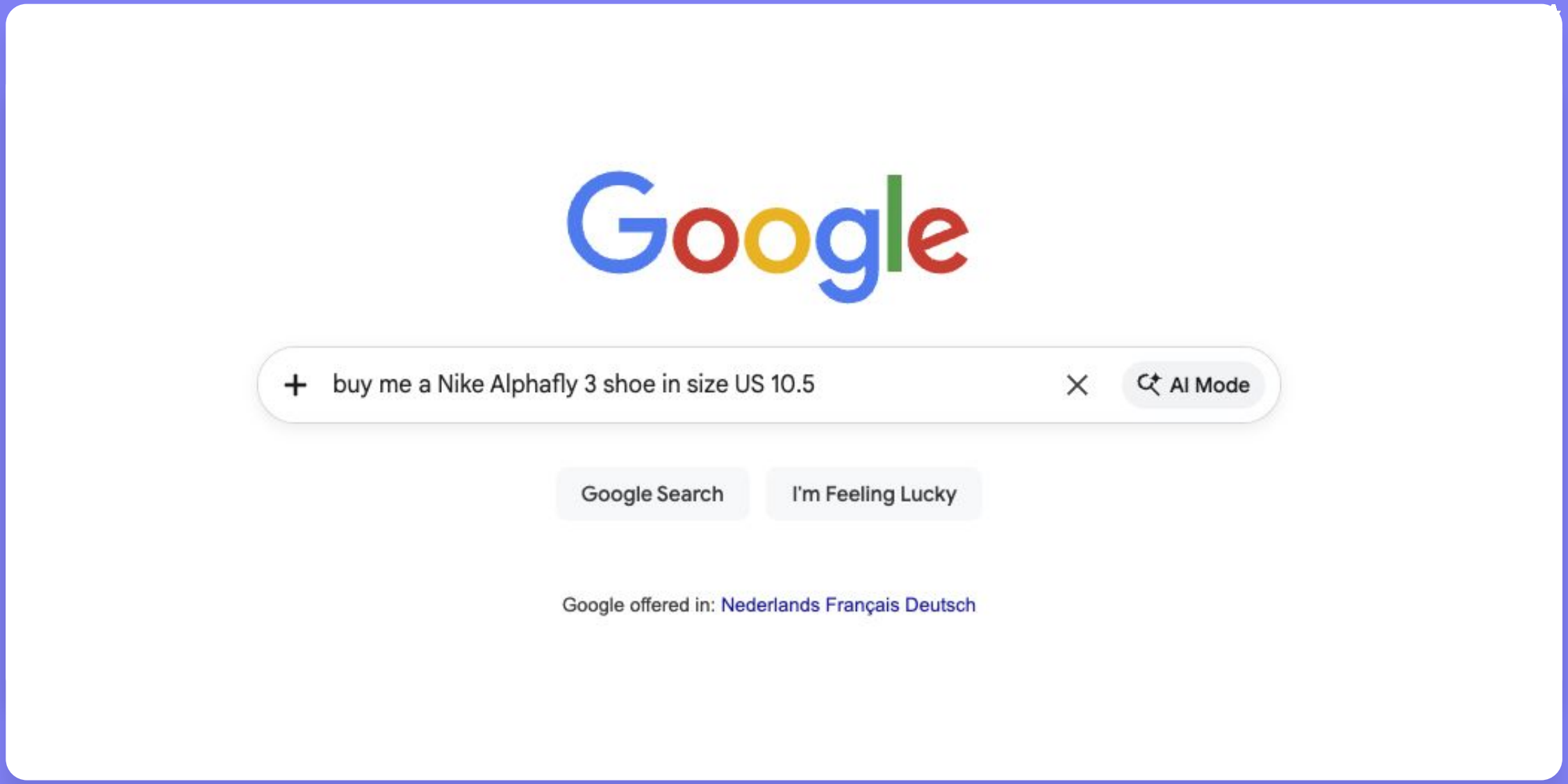
Algorand

Google Trends: “Agentic Commerce”




Google
buy me a Nike Alphafly 3 shoe in size US 10.5
AI Mode
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I'm Feeling Lucky
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What is it? How will it change commerce?

What is it?

/ AI Systems that act on behalf of users to make purchases.

/ Can anticipate needs, compare options, and execute transactions.

/ Operate autonomously based on consumers' prompts, with limited human interaction or oversight.

/ Agents don't browse products or content like humans. They extract structured data to make parameter-based decisions.

*Structural shift from **assisted AI** to **agentic AI***

How will it change commerce?

/ Fundamentally disrupts every step in the shopping journey:

- Discovery: From SEO to GXO.
- Comparison/review sites: Becomes algorithmic.
- Curation: Shifts from brand loyalty to machine data access.
- Personalization: Merchants must deploy agents to negotiate with shopper agents.
- Checkout: Frictionless, one-step checkout with agentic fraud prevention.
- Post Purchase: Challenges in user relationship building, loyalty, and chargebacks.

Massive disruption for traditional merchants who risk being left in the cold without an agentic infrastructure.

How will it create entirely new types of commerce?

/ Emergence of unified, collaborative, multi-agent ecosystems centered around reaching a particular goal, with extreme agent specialization.

/ Emergence of marketplaces where billions of agents interact and exchange value.

/ Emergence of new business models centered around micro-payments:

- From API key to pay-per-API
- Pay-as-you-go for premium content, data, compute or AI tokens
- Machine-to-machine IOT payments

Expected market size

Global Market Size Projections (by 2030)

$3 trillion to $5 trillion

in global orchestrated revenue is forecast by McKinsey & Company.

$10 to $12 trillion

in annual online sales, or roughly a quarter of all e-commerce, is what Kearney projects AI shopping agents could drive

$1.7 trillion by 2030

with a 67% CAGR from 2025, is Citi Ventures' estimate for the total addressable market (TAM) of C2B agentic commerce

50% of its revenue

within the next five years is what Walmart believes will come from AI agents

U.S. Market Size Projections (by 2030)

Up to $1 trillion

in orchestrated revenue is what McKinsey estimates the U.S. B2C retail market alone could see

$300 to $500 billion

or roughly 15% to 25% of overall e-commerce, is what Bain & Company estimates for the U.S. agentic commerce market

$190 billion to $385 billion

in U.S. e-commerce spending by 2030 is what Morgan Stanley estimates AI-powered 'agentic shoppers' could represent

How does crypto fit in?

Payment and trust layer for Agentic Commerce

/ **Payment rail:** instant, cheap, and feasible for small micro-transactions.

/ **Programmable**: smart contracts allow for instant multi-party settlement, escrowed intents, etc.

/ **Transparency and trust:** agent identities, reputation, and transaction history are recorded on-chain and can be verified and audited.

/ **Traceability:** every transaction and history of interactions is traceable and immutable all the time.

Emerging standards & protocols

Emerging protocols and standards on agentic identity and trust, payment rails, how Agents communicate with external resources, among themselves and with end user interfaces

MCP (Model Context Protocol) 11/24

A2A (Agent to Agent Protocol) 4/25

ACP (Agents Communication Protocol)

X402 (Internet-native payments) 5/25

AP2 (Agents Payments Protocol) 9/25

ERC 8004 (Trustless Agents Spec) 8/25

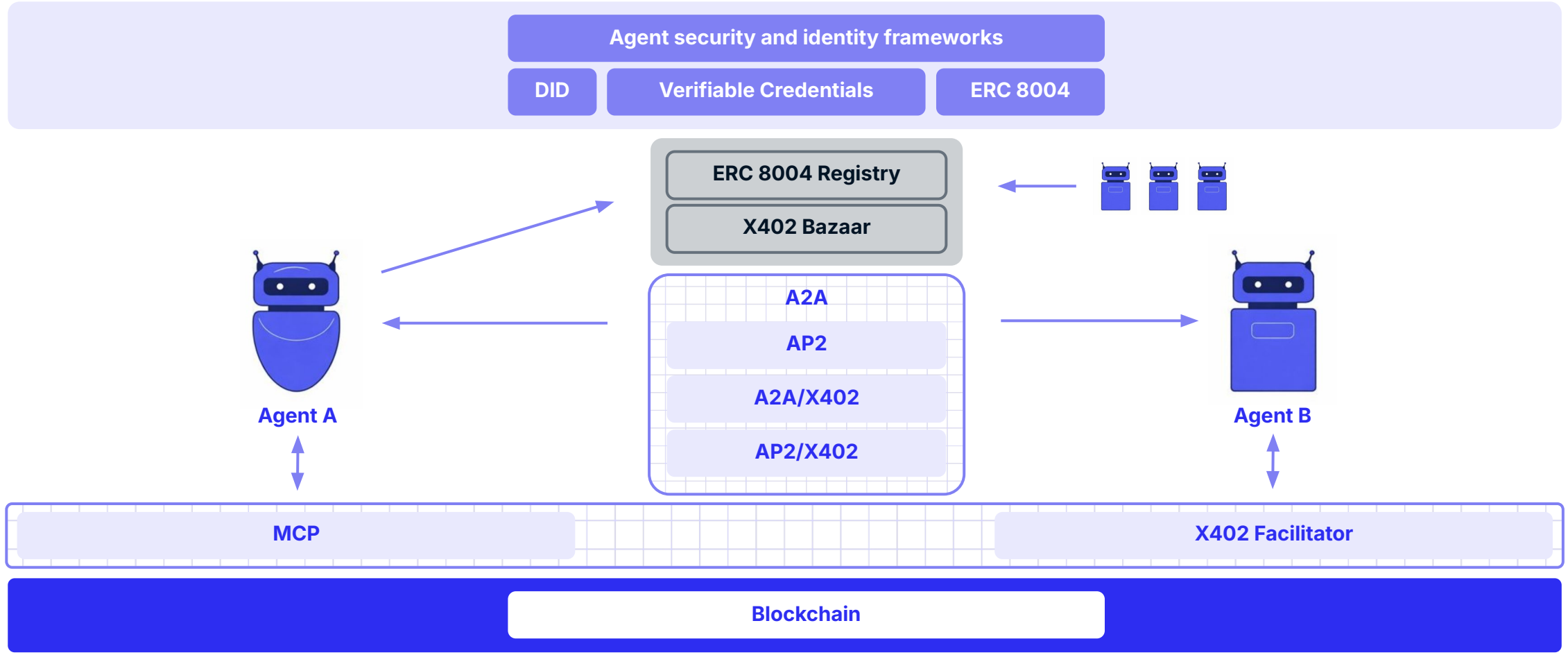
AGUI (Agentic GUI Protocol) 5/25

A2UI (Agents To UI spec) 12/25

UCP (Universal Commerce Protocol) 1/26

Architectural overview

Agentic rails blockchain integration



QuickTime Player File Edit View Window Help Fri Jan 16 10:03 AM

Inbox (4,291) - marcvl@ | Algorand A2A-AP2-X40 | Algorand Blockchain Ex | Demo 1: MCP Foundatio | Claude | Payment Required

commerce.goplausible.xyz

Relaunch to update

Gemini | Beastie | Music | Photos | Research | startup ideas | Cashback Compar... | Algorand | Burning Man | Reading | All Bookmarks

Algorand A2A-AP2-X402-MCP Agentic Commerce POC Playground

Shopper and merchant agents collaborate around Nike footwear agentic commerce in an A2A, AP2 and X402 enabled shopping experience flow.
Payment processor is an X402-AP2 extension for A2A. Shopper Agent uses OAuth protected MCP tools from Algorand Remote MCP for Agent wallet and AP2/X402 payments authorizations on Algorand.

View cart | Show debug | Clear chats

Shopper Agent

Personal shopping assistant with A2A/AP2/X402/Algorand skills

MCP: CONNECT | AGEN READ

Intent Mandate: empty | Cart sum: $0.00

Start by selecting a product (Intent Mandate) or cart to checkout (Cart Mandate).

A2A | AP2 | ALGORAND | X402 | MCP

Agentic Commerce FootWare Demo Shop

This Demo showcases a full agentic commerce experience based on Google A2A and AP2, Algorand blockchain, X402 payments and OAuth protected MCP tools for payment credentials and ops.

Note: The footware images and names are for presentation purposes only and do not represent real products.

Merchant Agent

Merchant agent with product catalog, inventory, sales and A2A/AP2/X402/Algorand skills.

AGENT: READY | X402: READY

Cart mandate: empty | Cart sum: $0.00

Follow Merchant and X402 Payment Processor A2A-AP2 agents messages here

X402 on Algorand

https://algorand.co/agentic-commerce/x402/developers

SECTION 6: OPENCLAW, CRYPTO & AI CONVERGENCE

AI Needs Crypto. Crypto Needs AI.

What AI Agents Need:

→ Wallets

→ Instant settlement

→ Programmable money

→ No KYC for code

What Crypto Needs:

→ Automation

→ Intelligence

→ Autonomous market-making

→ Smart routing

AI agents can't open bank accounts. They CAN hold a wallet and settle in 2 seconds on Solana.

Meet Max

What she does:

- Exec Assistant, Chief of Staff, Chief Architect
- Manages the business end to end in real time with me
- Running 24/7 in my home office right now
- Costs $5k per month!!!

Every person has an AI agent. Every agent has a wallet.
That's the next decade.

The Agent Economy Is Here

- AI agents trading on DEXs — volume growing 10× YoY
- Autonomous market makers optimizing liquidity
- Agent-to-agent commerce: compute, data, services
- AI-generated content with crypto micropayments
- This isn't 5 years out — it's happening now.

The Prediction

Billions of AI agents transacting 24/7 by 2030

The next 10 years of crypto won't be driven by humans clicking buttons.
It'll be driven by billions of AI agents transacting around the clock.

SECTION 7: CORPORATE TREASURY — BE LIKE MIKE

Be Like Mike

MSTR Stock	**$15 (2020) → $300+ (2026)**
BTC Holdings	**250,000+ BTC**
Result	**Best corporate finance decision of the decade**

Saw cash losing 5-7%/year to inflation. Said "what if I just bought Bitcoin?"

Your Cash Is Melting

$1M corporate cash	→ worth ~$930K after 1 year (real terms)
Money market	→ 2-3% (barely keeps up with inflation)
Bitcoin 4-year CAGR	→ Never negative in any rolling 4-year window

How to Start — A Framework for CEOs

Step 1 5-20% of corporate cash reserves

Step 2 SMA structure — direct ownership, fiduciary, auditable

Step 3 FASB fair value rules now allow mark-to-market

Step 4 Hold >1 year for long-term capital gains

You don't need to go full Saylor. Start with 5% and use an SMA.

Your Corporate Cash Should Be Working

Stablecoin Yield: 7-15% APY

vs Money Market: 2-3%

- No price risk (dollar-denominated)
- Same-day liquidity
- USDAF + sUSDAF: Abra's stablecoin with built-in yield

Same dollar exposure. Double the yield. That's better treasury management.

Who's Already Doing This

- MicroStrategy
- Tesla
- Block (Square)
- MassMutual
- Marathon Digital
- El Salvador
- Metaplanet (Japan)

70+ public companies now hold Bitcoin on their balance sheet

If you have a company with $1M+ in cash, talk to someone about digital asset treasury this quarter.

SECTION 8: PERSONAL WEALTH & THE SMA

The Allocation Framework

🟢 **Conservative — 1-5% of liquid net worth**

Bitcoin only. Hold 4+ years. Done.

🟡 **Moderate — 5-15%**

BTC + ETH + stablecoin yield. SMA structure.

🔴 **Aggressive — 15-30%+**

Full portfolio: BTC, ETH, SOL, DeFi yield, tokenized assets.

Pick your tier based on conviction. Brand new? Go green — 2% in Bitcoin, hold 4 years, forget about it.

Earning Yield on Crypto — The Safe Way

Stablecoin Yield	**5-15% APY**	USDC, USDAF
Bitcoin Yield	**2-5% APY**	Covered calls, lending
Staking	**3-8% APY**	SOL ~8%, ETH ~3-4%

Real yield without gambling. Stablecoin lending at 8-12% is providing liquidity, not speculation.

The Don'ts

❌ **Meme coins**	Unless it's money you can lose at a casino
❌ **Excessive Leverage**	It kills people — every cycle
❌ **Self-custody if you're not technical**	Keys lost = money gone forever
❌ **Day trading**	You will lose to bots and quants

12 years in this space. Every cycle destroys people who do these things. Just don't.

Make Sure Your Heirs Can Access Your Crypto

- SMA advantage: fiduciary manages succession automatically
- Self-custody risk: keys die with you
- Multi-sig solutions and dead man switches exist but are complex
- Crypto-literate estate attorneys are essential
- If you self-custody $5M in Bitcoin and get hit by a bus, your family can't access it.

Your Action Plan

1. **Open an SMA account this month**
2. Fund it with 2% of your portfolio
3. Buy Bitcoin
4. Get more sophisticated later

Follow Bill: @billbarX on X

Welcome to the exponential age of finance.